PriX: Private Accelerated Transformers via Secure Multi-Party Computation in JAX

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Abstract

Private inference of Transformer and Large Language Models (LLMs) via Secure Multi-Party Computation (MPC) faces a systems bottleneck: CrypTen-family frameworks execute secret-shared protocols over $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ via eager, operator-by-operator dispatch in PyTorch. While recent algorithmic advances—Wavelet-encoded Look-Up Tables (Curl), piecewise low-degree polynomials (PUMA, BOLT, Nimbus), 1-round Fourier-series activations and ODE Softmax (SHAFT), and hybrid plaintext evaluators (Fission)—substantially reduce the cost of nonlinearities, their reference implementations are spread across separate codebases and pay kernel-launch and host-side dispatch overhead on every elementary ring operation.

We present **PriX**, an open-source JAX/XLA framework for private Transformer inference that implements five MPC approximation paradigms (**CrypTen**, **PUMA/BOLT/Nimbus piecewise polynomials**, **SHAFT**, **Curl**, and **Fission**) under a single API while compiling local ring operations into fused XLA kernels. PriX combines (1) *exact limb-decomposed FP64 matrix multiplication* over $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ that computes only the limb products surviving modulo 2^{64} (6 products with 22-bit limbs for contraction size $K \leq 512$, 10 products with 16-bit limbs otherwise); (2) `@jax.jit` *fusion* of the local steps of multi-round MPC circuits (carry-lookahead comparison rounds, wavelet LUT gathers, Fourier-series combinations); and (3) *a pickle-free peer-to-peer TCP transport*, with optional mutual TLS, that exchanges batched openings as single messages and runs unchanged on one host or across machines. Across 10 MPC primitives and 5 Transformer blocks (`BertTiny`, `BertBase`, `GPT2`, `Llama`, `ModernBert`) in all five modes, PriX has lower latency than the PyTorch CrypTen baseline in all 75 configurations on both a CPU and an NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPU. With both frameworks communicating over TCP, Transformer-block speedups are **2.32**×–**7.77**× (geometric mean 4.14×) on CPU and **1.91**×–**3.08**× (geometric mean 2.33×) on GPU. A transport comparison shows that most of the speedup does not depend on the transport: run over CrypTen's own `gloo` transport, PriX is still 3.14× faster on Transformer blocks on CPU and 2.17× on GPU (geometric means), and a shared-memory transport would add only 4–5%. Both frameworks run on a single host, so these measurements reflect computation and inter-process overhead rather than wide-area network cost.

1 Introduction

Deploying Transformer-based Large Language Models (LLMs) [24] on sensitive user prompts or proprietary model weights requires cryptographic privacy guarantees. Secure Multi-Party Computation (MPC) over the machine ring $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ [17, 19, 12, 8] enables two or more distrusting parties to jointly evaluate neural networks on secret-shared inputs without revealing either the client's prompt or the server's parameters.

Over the past five years, CrypTen [12] has served as the foundational Python research platform for machine-learning-oriented MPC. Building upon CrypTen, a wave of recent cryptographic protocol innovations has dramatically improved the accuracy and round complexity of Transformer nonlinearities (GeLU, SiLU, Softmax, LayerNorm, RMSNorm):

- **Wavelet Approximations and Curl** [6, 20, 21]: Wavelet-based cryptographic function approximation—pioneered across Fully Homomorphic Encryption in **Ripple** [6], mixed-mode MPC in **Wave Hello to Privacy** [20], and private LLM evaluation in **Curl** [21]—compresses lookup tables via Haar and Biorthogonal-2.2 wavelet transforms paired with probabilistic truncation (TruncPr) [5], substantially reducing LUT communication and memory footprints while preserving high numerical fidelity.
- **SHAFT** [10] introduced 1-round trigonometric-triple Fourier-series evaluation for GeLU, SiLU, Erf, Sigmoid, and Tanh, alongside a constant-round Forward-Euler Ordinary Differential Equation (ODE) solver for Softmax.
- **Fission** [23] introduced a hybrid permute-and-reveal architecture that offloads elementwise nonlinearities to a non-colluding plaintext evaluator party.
- **PUMA** [4], **BOLT** [18], and **Nimbus** [15] replace GeLU, SiLU, and exp with piecewise low-degree polynomials guarded by one or two secure comparisons, avoiding lookup tables entirely: BOLT folds the input domain onto $|x|$ using the even symmetry of $\mathrm{GeLU}(x) - \mathrm{ReLU}(x)$, and Nimbus fits the pieces to the observed input distributions of Transformer activations.

Despite these algorithmic advances, MPC research for Transformers faces two systems obstacles:

1. **Ecosystem Fragmentation:** The original CrypTen repository was archived in May 2025, and Curl, SHAFT, and Fission live in separate CrypTen forks (PUMA lives in SecretFlow SPU), each of which needs compatibility patches to run on current Python, PyTorch, and JAX releases. Researchers conducting ablations across approximation paradigms must port models between distinct codebases.
2. **Eager Dispatch Overhead:** In eager PyTorch, every elementary bitwise shift, mask, and ring addition in an MPC circuit is a separate CPU or CUDA kernel launch with host-side Python control flow in between. A single 64-bit carry-lookahead comparison [13] executes 6 tree rounds of bitwise XOR and AND operations, so its local work is split into many tiny launches. In addition, because neither CPUs' BLAS libraries nor CUDA provide 64-bit integer (`int64`) GEMM, CrypTen's CUDA backend splits each operand into 3 (for contraction size $K < 256$) or 4 limbs and computes all 9 or 16 pairwise limb products in one batched FP64 `torch.matmul`, discarding the products that vanish modulo 2^{64} only afterwards; on CPU it falls back to PyTorch's unblocked `int64` matmul.

To address both challenges, we design and implement **PriX** (*Private Accelerated Transformers in JAX*), a modern, drop-in alternative to CrypTen built on the JAX/XLA compiler stack [2].

Contributions. Our contributions are:

1. **A Multi-Paradigm MPC Framework:** PriX implements **CrypTen** polynomial/Newton–Raphson approximations [12], **PUMA / BOLT / Nimbus**-style piecewise low-degree polynomials [4, 18, 15], **SHAFT** Fourier-series and ODE Softmax [10], **Curl** wavelet LUTs with TruncPr [21, 5], and **Fission** hybrid evaluators [23] behind a single API on Python 3.10–3.13,

tested on CPUs and CUDA GPUs. Researchers switch paradigms in one line (`mode="lut" | "poly" | "shaft" | "crypten" | "fission"`) or mix methods per function (e.g., SHAFT ODE Softmax with Curl wavelet LayerNorm).

2. **XLA Kernel Fusion for MPC Circuits:** PriX compiles the local (non-communicating) steps of secret-share arithmetic, carry-lookahead comparison rounds, wavelet LUT gathers, and Fourier-series combinations via `@jax.jit`, removing intermediate memory traffic and Python dispatch between elementary ring operations.

3. **Exact Limb-Decomposed $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ Matrix Multiplication and Low-Overhead Collectives:** PriX computes only the limb products that survive modulo 2^{64} (6 instead of CrypTen's 9 for $K < 256$, 6 instead of 16 for $256 \le K \le 512$, and 10 instead of 16 for $K > 512$) inside one compiled kernel, and exchanges batched openings over a pickle-free peer-to-peer TCP transport with optional mutual TLS.

4. **CPU and GPU Evaluation:** We compare PriX against the PyTorch CrypTen baseline on 10 primitives and 5 Transformer blocks (`BertTiny`, `BertBase`, `GPT2`, `Llama`, `ModernBert`) in all 5 modes on a CPU and an NVIDIA Tesla T4 GPU (75 configurations each). PriX has lower latency in every configuration, with **2.32**×–**7.77**× Transformer-block speedups on CPU and **1.91**×–**3.08**× on GPU. A transport comparison measures how much of the speedup depends on the transport (PriX over `gloo`, its own TCP, and shared memory) on both platforms, an accuracy sweep reports each mode's error and valid input ranges, and we document the remaining limits of the measurements: a single host and few repetitions.

2 Background and MPC Preliminaries

2.1 Fixed-Point Encoding and Secret Sharing over $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$

Real-valued tensors $x \in \mathbb{R}^{d_1 \times \cdots \times d_k}$ are encoded into the ring $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ using a fixed-point scaling factor $S = 2^f$ (where $f = 16$ precision bits by default):

$$\mathsf{Encode}(x) = \lfloor x \cdot 2^f \rceil \bmod 2^{64}, \qquad \mathsf{Decode}(\hat{x}) = \frac{\mathsf{Signed}_{64}(\hat{x})}{2^f}. \tag{1}$$

Across N parties (typically $N = 2$), PriX maintains two secret-sharing representations:

- **Additive Arithmetic Sharing ($\langle x \rangle^A$):** Party $p \in \{0, \ldots, N-1\}$ holds $\langle x \rangle_p^A \in \mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$ such that $\sum_{p=0}^{N-1} \langle x \rangle_p^A \equiv \mathsf{Encode}(x) \pmod{2^{64}}$. Linear combinations $\langle x + y \rangle^A = \langle x \rangle^A + \langle y \rangle^A$ and public multiplications $\langle c \cdot x \rangle^A = c \cdot \langle x \rangle^A$ require zero communication (followed by local or interactive fixed-point truncation).

- **XOR Binary Sharing ($\langle x \rangle^B$):** Party p holds $\langle x \rangle_p^B \in \{0,1\}^{64}$ such that $\bigoplus_{p=0}^{N-1} \langle x \rangle_p^B = x$. Bitwise XOR ($\oplus$) and bit shifts ($\ll, \gg$) are local; bitwise AND ($\wedge$) requires 1 communication round via binary Beaver triples.

2.2 Multiplication, Truncation, and Nonlinearity Paradigms

Beaver Multiplication Triples. To compute the private product $\langle z \rangle^A = \langle x \cdot y \rangle^A$ (or matrix product $\langle XY \rangle^A$), the parties consume a pre-generated triple $(\langle a \rangle^A, \langle b \rangle^A, \langle c \rangle^A)$ with $c = a \cdot b \bmod$

2^{64} [1]. Parties locally compute $\langle \epsilon \rangle^A = \langle x \rangle^A - \langle a \rangle^A$ and $\langle \delta \rangle^A = \langle y \rangle^A - \langle b \rangle^A$, open (ϵ, δ) in a single communication round, and evaluate:

$$\langle x \cdot y \rangle_p^A = \langle c \rangle_p^A + \epsilon \langle b \rangle_p^A + \langle a \rangle_p^A \delta + \mathbb{I}[p = 0] \cdot (\epsilon\delta) \pmod{2^{64}}. \tag{2}$$

Because multiplying two 2^f-scaled integers yields scale 2^{2f}, the product must be truncated by f bits:

- *CrypTen Truncation (`crypten`):* With two parties, each party arithmetic-shifts its own share by f bits with no communication (local share truncation, as in CrypTen [12] and SecureML [17]); PriX folds this shift into the compiled Beaver combination. The result is correct up to one unit in the last place, except with probability about $|x|/2^{63}$ for a ring value x, when the shares wrap and the result is wrong by a large amount. With more than two parties, CrypTen's masked wrap-count protocol corrects for the wraps θ_x in one extra round.
- *Probabilistic Truncation (`egk`):* Following Escudero et al. [5] and Curl [21], parties mask $\langle z \rangle^A$ with a correlated random pair $(\langle r \rangle^A, \langle r \gg f \rangle^A)$, reveal $z + r$, and subtract $\langle r \gg f \rangle^A$ from $(z + r) \gg f$.

Five Nonlinear Approximation Backends. Table 1 summarizes the five approximation modes unified in PriX:

1. **CrypTen Mode (`mode="crypten"`)** [12]: Approximates $\exp(x) \approx (1 + x/2^m)^{2^m}$ via $m = 8$ repeated squarings, $1/x$ and $1/\sqrt{x}$ via Newton–Raphson iterations, and $\mathrm{GeLU}(x)$ via Taylor-series $\mathrm{erf}(x/\sqrt{2})$.
2. **PUMA / BOLT / Nimbus Piecewise Polynomial Mode (`mode="poly"`)** [4, 18, 15]: Evaluates GeLU, SiLU, Tanh, Sigmoid, and Erf with one batched secure comparison (computing $[\langle x \rangle^A < 0]$ and $[|\langle x \rangle^A| < w]$ in a single carry-lookahead circuit) followed by a degree-4 polynomial on $|x|$ (using BOLT's symmetry folding $\mathrm{ReLU}(x) + \mathbb{I}[|x| < w]\, P(|x|)$ for GeLU and SiLU), and exp with a two-piece degree-4 polynomial on $(-5, 0]$ and $[0, 2.5]$ whose pieces share one power basis. No lookup tables are used. The coefficients are least-squares fits over the stated intervals rather than the distribution-aware fits of Nimbus.
3. **SHAFT Mode (`mode="shaft"`)** [10]: Evaluates GeLU, SiLU, Erf, Sigmoid, and Tanh via a Fourier sine series $\sum_{k=1}^{K} \beta_k \sin(k\omega x)$ whose evaluation takes *1 communication round*: parties reveal $\delta = x - t$ against a pre-shared trigonometric triple $(\langle t \rangle^A, \langle \sin(k\omega t) \rangle^A, \langle \cos(k\omega t) \rangle^A)$ and apply the angle-addition identity locally:

   $$\langle \sin(k\omega x) \rangle^A = \sin(k\omega\delta) \langle \cos(k\omega t) \rangle^A + \cos(k\omega\delta) \langle \sin(k\omega t) \rangle^A. \tag{3}$$

   The series is only accurate within one period, so for GeLU and SiLU PriX first computes $[x < 0]$ and $[|x| < w]$ in one batched comparison, evaluates the series on $|x|$, and selects between it and $\mathrm{ReLU}(x)$; the comparison dominates the round count (11 rounds per GeLU in our measurements). For Softmax, SHAFT integrates the differential equation $y'(t) = y(t) \odot (x - \langle y(t), x \rangle)$ over $t \in [0, 1]$ using a fixed number of Forward-Euler steps, without any division, reciprocal, or secure max.
4. **Curl Wavelet LUT Mode (`mode="lut"`)** [21]: Builds on wavelet-based function approximation [6, 20]: lookup tables are compressed with Haar and Biorthogonal-2.2 wavelet transforms into coarse coefficient tables, secret-shared lookups are evaluated with one-hot correlated randomness [21], and Biorthogonal-2.2 tables are interpolated piecewise-linearly after probabilistic truncation TruncPr [5].

Table 1: Summary of the five MPC approximation paradigms implemented in PriX (default configuration of each mode).

Mode	Truncation	GeLU / SiLU	Softmax	Reciprocal / InvSqrt
`"crypten"` [12]	Local shift	Taylor erf / Sigmoid	Secure max + limit exp + NR recip.	Newton–Raphson
`"poly"` [4, 18, 15]	Local shift	Piecewise degree-4 poly	Secure max + piecewise exp + NR recip.	Newton–Raphson
`"shaft"` [10]	Local shift	Fourier series + comparison	Forward-Euler ODE	Newton–Raphson
`"lut"` [21]	TruncPr [5]	Bior-2.2 LUT	Secure max + Bior-2.2 exp / recip. LUTs	Bior-2.2 LUT
`"fission"` [23]	Deferred / Evaluator	Permute & reveal	Permute & reveal	Permute & reveal

5. **Fission Evaluator Mode (`mode="fission"`)** [23]: Masks and randomly permutes shares before revealing them to a non-colluding plaintext evaluator party, which computes exact float32 nonlinearities and returns fresh secret shares. The evaluator learns the permuted plaintext values, so the security argument relies on the evaluator not colluding with the MPC parties and on partitioning values across evaluators [23].

2.3 Threat Model

PriX targets the setting of CrypTen and its descendants: $N \geq 2$ computing parties, typically two, that hold additive shares of the model weights and inputs and are *semi-honest*, i.e. they follow the protocol but may try to learn from what they see. We assume no collusion between computing parties. Correlated randomness comes from a dealer: either Party 0 itself (`TFP`, which is only meaningful for benchmarking, since Party 0 then knows every mask) or a separate non-colluding dealer process (`TTP`). In `fission` mode, an additional evaluator party sees masked, permuted plaintext values of each nonlinearity's input and must not collude with the computing parties (permutations are derived from a seed shared only among the computing parties, so neither the evaluator nor the `TTP` dealer learns them). Malicious parties, active attacks, and side channels such as timing are out of scope, as are model-extraction attacks on the revealed output. Section 6 lists the ways in which the current implementation falls short of even this model.

3 PriX Architecture and XLA Compiler Optimizations

Figure 1 presents the four-layer architecture of PriX. Eager PyTorch frameworks launch each ring-arithmetic or bitwise operation as its own kernel. PriX instead expresses the local (non-communicating) phase between two openings of a protocol as a pure function over 64-bit JAX arrays (`jnp.int64` / `jnp.uint64`) and compiles it with `@jax.jit`, so each such phase becomes one XLA executable. Communication remains on the host between compiled phases.

3.1 Exact Limb-Decomposed FP64 Matrix Multiplication over $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$

Neither CPU BLAS libraries nor cuBLAS provide 64-bit integer (`int64`) GEMM, so PyTorch's `int64` matmul runs on generic unblocked loops. Double-precision GEMM, by contrast, is available in optimized form on both (AVX/FMA on CPU, `cublasDgemm` on GPU). Note that on the Tesla T4 used in our GPU experiments, FP64 throughput is a small fraction of FP32 throughput and does not use tensor cores.

To compute $C = AB \bmod 2^{64}$ for $A \in \mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}^{M\times K}$ and $B \in \mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}^{K\times N}$ exactly in FP64, we split each unsigned 64-bit entry into L limbs of w bits, $A = \sum_i A_i 2^{wi}$ and $B = \sum_j B_j 2^{wj}$. Because only the result modulo 2^{64} is needed, every limb pair with $(i + j)\, w \geq 64$ contributes a multiple of 2^{64} and

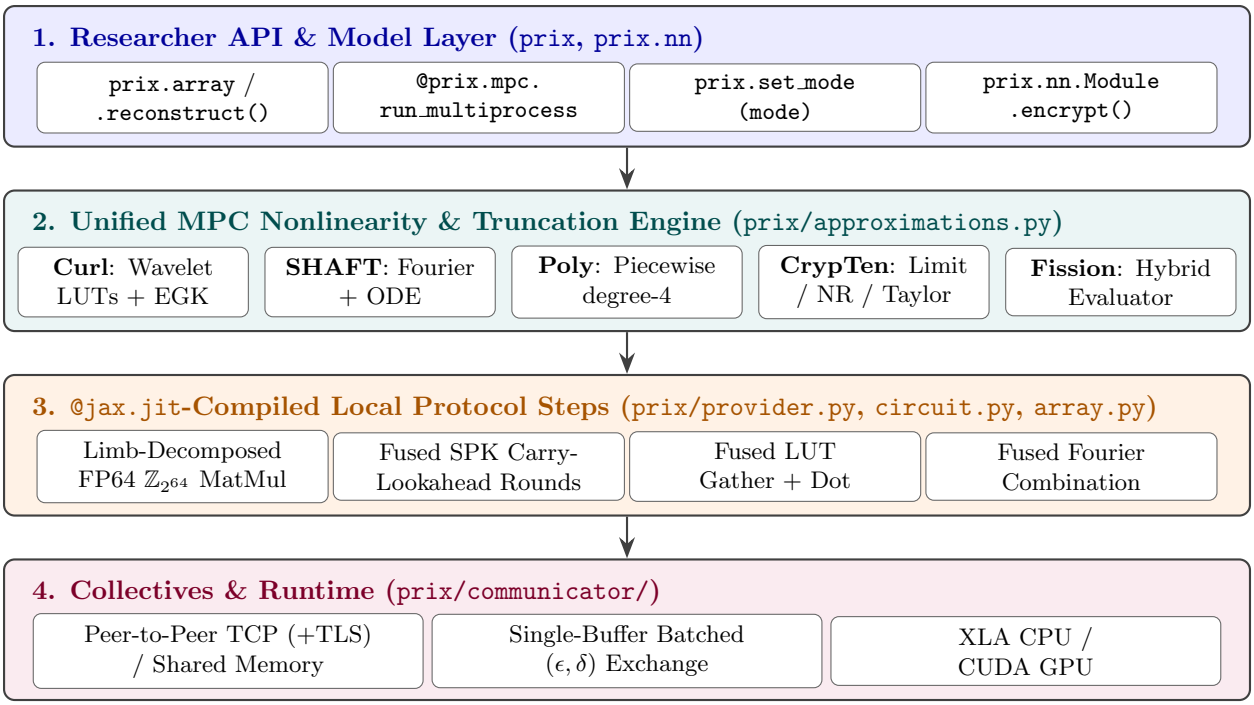


Figure 1: System architecture of **PriX**, from the researcher-facing Python API down to compiled local protocol steps and transports.

can be skipped:

$$AB \equiv \sum_{(i+j)\, w<64} (A_i B_j)\, 2^{w(i+j)} \pmod{2^{64}}. \tag{4}$$

PriX uses two limb configurations, chosen by the contraction size K:

- $K \le 512$: $L = 3$ limbs of $w = 22$ bits (A_2, B_2 have 20 bits), so only the **6** pairs with $i + j \le 2$ are computed. Each product entry is below $K \cdot 2^{44} \le 2^{53}$, so every FP64 GEMM is exact.
- $K > 512$: $L = 4$ limbs of $w = 16$ bits, so only the **10** pairs with $i + j \le 3$ are computed. On GPU each pair is a separate slice of one batched GEMM. Each pair product is converted to `uint64` individually, which is exact for $K \cdot 2^{32} \le 2^{53}$, i.e. $K \le 2^{21}$. On CPU, each pair product is likewise converted to `uint64` before products of equal shift are added, so both backends share the same $K \le 2^{21}$ bound.
- $K > 2^{21}$: the contraction is split into chunks of at most 2^{21}. Each chunk is multiplied exactly as above, and the `uint64` partial results are added; wrap-around addition is exact modulo 2^{64}, so the result is bit-exact for any K. The chunking is decided at trace time, so it adds no overhead when $K \le 2^{21}$.

CrypTen's CUDA backend [12] uses 3 limbs for $K < 256$ and 4 limbs otherwise, and computes *all* 9 or 16 limb products in one batched `torch.matmul` before discarding the vanishing ones. PriX therefore performs 6 instead of 9 GEMMs for $K < 256$, 6 instead of 16 for $256 \le K \le 512$, and 10 instead of 16 for $K > 512$. On GPU, PriX stacks the surviving limb pairs into one batched GEMM, and the limb extraction, GEMM, conversion, shifts, and modular accumulation are compiled together with the Beaver combination $\langle C \rangle^A + \epsilon \langle B \rangle^A + \langle A \rangle^A \delta + \mathbb{I}[p = 0](\epsilon\delta)$. On

CPU, CrypTen uses PyTorch's `int64` matmul directly, so PriX's advantage there comes mainly from using FP64 BLAS.

3.2 Compiled Set-Propagate-Kill Comparison Circuits

Private comparisons ($\langle x \rangle^A < 0$, ReLU, Max) extract the most significant bit of a secret-shared ring element by converting $\langle x \rangle^A$ into binary shares with a parallel-prefix carry-lookahead circuit. Like CrypTen, PriX uses a carry-lookahead adder built from set/propagate (Set-Propagate-Kill, SPK) carry signals [3], arranged as a Kogge–Stone parallel-prefix tree [13] with $\log_2 64 = 6$ rounds. In round r with stride $s = 2^r$, the set and propagate bit-vectors are updated as

$$S^{(r+1)} = S^{(r)} \oplus \big(P^{(r)} \wedge (S^{(r)} \ll s)\big), \qquad P^{(r+1)} = P^{(r)} \wedge (P^{(r)} \ll s), \tag{5}$$

where XOR can replace OR because the two terms are never both set. As in CrypTen, both AND gates of a round are opened in one batched binary-Beaver exchange. PriX differs in how the local work is executed:

- The dealer generates the binary triples for all 6 rounds in one call (`generate_spk_triples`) instead of one call per round.
- The local work between two consecutive openings—applying the previous round's Beaver correction, masking, shifting, and preparing the next round's masked operands—is one compiled kernel (`_spk_step_fused` in `circuit.py`). The first and last rounds are fused with the arithmetic-to-binary conversion and with the binary-to-arithmetic conversion of the sign bit, respectively (`_a2b_post_and_spk_round0_pre`, `_spk_round_last_and_ltz_b2a_pre`, `_b2a_combine`).

3.3 Compiled Wavelet LUT Evaluation and Fourier Combination

In Curl mode (`mode="lut"`), a nonlinearity such as InvSqrt, Exp, GeLU, or SiLU truncates the secret input to a table index, reveals the index masked by a one-hot correlation, rotates the one-hot share accordingly, and takes its dot product with the (Biorthogonal-2.2) coefficient tables before interpolating. In PriX:

- Each wavelet table is built on first use, placed on the accelerator, and cached for the rest of the session (`LookupTables(device)`), so table construction is excluded from the timed runs by the warmup.
- The rotation and dot product against one table, or against the two Biorthogonal-2.2 tables used for interpolation, are one compiled kernel (`_lut_gather_dot`, `_bior_lut_gather_dot` in `array.py`).
- In SHAFT mode, after the single opening of $\delta = x - t$, the evaluation of Equation 3 for all K terms—computing $\sin(k\omega\delta)$ and $\cos(k\omega\delta)$, scaling them by β_k, multiplying against the triple shares, and summing—is one compiled kernel (`_fourier_linear_comb_jit` in `approximations.py`).

3.4 Batched Openings and Transports

Every private multiplication opens two masked tensors, $\epsilon = x - a$ and $\delta = y - b$. As in CrypTen, both are opened in one round. When ϵ and δ have different shapes (e.g. $\epsilon \in \mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}^{M \times K}$ and $\delta \in \mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}^{K \times N}$

in a matrix multiplication), PriX passes both to one batched `all_reduce`, which sends them as a single message and splits the result.

PriX's default transport is **peer-to-peer TCP**: every pair of processes (MPC parties, the TTP dealer if used, and Fission evaluators) shares one direct connection, with no coordinator in the data path, and the same code runs on one host over loopback or across machines. Messages use a small binary format that carries only plain data and numeric arrays, so, unlike pickle, decoding a malicious peer's message cannot execute code. Sockets are non-blocking, and every wait keeps flushing queued outgoing data, so two parties that send each other large openings at the same time cannot deadlock. Connections can optionally use mutual TLS with a shared certificate authority; all experiments here run without TLS, like CrypTen's transport. For single-host simulation, PriX also offers a **shared-memory transport**: a 4-slot ring buffer (`multiprocessing.RawArray`) per party with a 1-byte pipe message as the readiness signal, with slots of 2^{21} `int64` values (16 MiB) and a pickled-queue fallback for larger openings. CrypTen uses `torch.distributed` with the `gloo` backend over loopback TCP. Section 5.4 compares all three.

4 Researcher Ergonomics and Unified API

A central design goal of PriX is enabling cryptography and machine learning researchers to prototype and benchmark private Transformer protocols with minimal boilerplate. Listing 1 shows a multi-party ablation that evaluates a pre-norm Transformer block under all five approximation modes.

Listing 1: Evaluating a private Transformer block under all five MPC approximation modes in PriX.

```
import numpy as np
import prix
import prix.nn as nn

class TransformerBlock(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, d_model=64, n_heads=4, d_ff=256):
        super().__init__()
        self.ln1 = nn.LayerNorm(d_model)
        self.attn = nn.MultiheadAttention(d_model, n_heads)
        self.ln2 = nn.LayerNorm(d_model)
        self.ffn = nn.Sequential(nn.Linear(d_model, d_ff), nn.GELU(), nn.Linear(
            d_ff, d_model))

    def forward(self, x):
        h = self.ln1(x)
        x = x + self.attn(h, h, h)
        return x + self.ffn(self.ln2(x))

def evaluate_private_block(tokens):
    # Party 0 secret-shares the model weights; party 1 secret-shares the token
        embeddings
    model = TransformerBlock().encrypt(src=0)
    x = prix.array(tokens, src=1)
    return model(x).reconstruct()

tokens = np.random.randn(1, 16, 64).astype(np.float32)
for mode in ["crypten", "poly", "shaft", "lut", "fission"]:
    out = prix.run(evaluate_private_block, tokens, world_size=2, mode=mode)
```

5 Experimental Evaluation

5.1 Experimental Setup

We compare **PriX (JAX)** against a PyTorch **CrypTen** baseline [12]: the CrypTen fork that serves as the reference implementation of Curl [21] and Fission [23]. SHAFT's Fourier activations and ODE Softmax [10], and the piecewise polynomials of `poly` mode, are added to this baseline by our benchmark script. The SHAFT functions follow the SHAFT authors' CrypTen-based reference implementation, which computes GeLU/SiLU with ReLU followed by a separate range comparison. PUMA, BOLT, and Nimbus have no CrypTen implementation, so the `poly` functions are ports of PriX's algorithms with the same coefficients, intervals, batched comparisons, and power-basis sharing. Where PriX seeds Newton–Raphson iterations with the limit approximation of exp regardless of the configured exp method, the baseline is configured the same way. Both frameworks run 2-party semi-honest protocols with the Trusted First Party (`TFP`) dealer, $f = 16$ fractional bits, identical inputs, and identical configurations: each mode's YAML is merged over the framework's default configuration, and the CrypTen side then takes PriX's value for every setting both define, including the adjusted LUT ranges of Section 5.5 (a configuration change only; the baseline code is unchanged). The five modes are:

1. **CrypTen approximations (`crypten`)** [12];
2. **Piecewise polynomials (`poly`)** [4, 18, 15];
3. **SHAFT Fourier + ODE (`shaft`)** [10];
4. **Curl wavelet LUTs with `TruncPr` (`lut`)** [21]; and
5. **Fission hybrid evaluator (`fission`)** [23], with one evaluator process.

We benchmark 10 MPC primitives and nonlinearities (MatMul 128×128, Mul 128×128, ReLU 32×64, Exp 32×64, Reciprocal 32×64, InvSqrt 32×64, GeLU 32×64, SiLU 32×64, Softmax 4×32×32, LayerNorm $4 \times 32 \times 64$) and 5 Transformer configurations with sequence length $L = 16$: `BertTiny` (2 blocks, $d = 128$, $H = 2$), `BertBase` (1 block, $d = 768$, $H = 12$), `GPT2` (1 block, $d = 768$, $H = 12$), `Llama` (1 block, $d = 768$, $H = 12$, $H_{\text{kv}} = 4$, RoPE + SwiGLU + RMSNorm, grouped-query attention), and `ModernBert` (1 block, $d = 768$, $H = 12$, RoPE + GeGLU). Weights and inputs are random; we measure latency only, not model accuracy.

Methodology. All parties run as separate processes on one host and communicate over loopback TCP: CrypTen through `torch.distributed/gloo`, and PriX through its own peer-to-peer TCP transport (Section 3.4), without TLS in either case. No network latency or bandwidth limit is emulated. Each primitive is run 2 times untimed (to exclude JIT compilation and cache warmup) and then timed 5 times; each Transformer block is warmed up once and timed 3 times. Parties synchronize with a barrier before every timed run, device work is synchronized before the timer stops, and we report the median. Communication statistics (rounds and bytes) were recorded in all runs. On each platform, all configurations (CrypTen, and PriX over each of its three transports; Section 5.4) were measured in one session (on CPU, rotating the order of the four runs between modes so that slow drift of the host does not favor one of them). CPU experiments use the host listed in Table 2's caption. GPU experiments use a Google Colab instance with one NVIDIA Tesla T4. With so few repetitions, differences of roughly 10% or less between the two frameworks should be treated as within run-to-run noise.

Figures 2–4 summarize the results; Tables 2–5 give the underlying numbers.

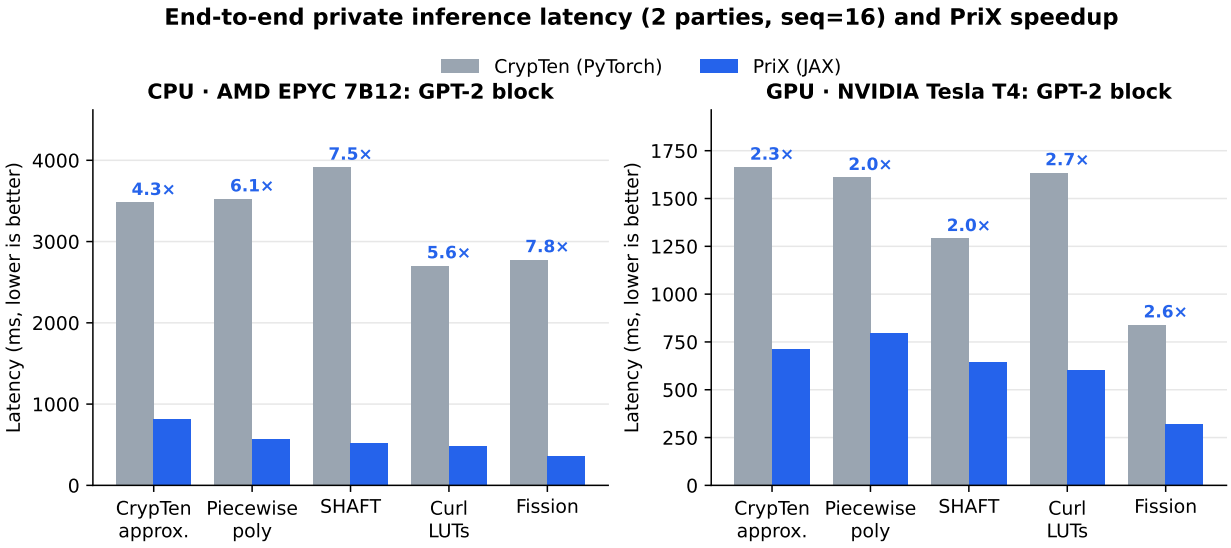


Figure 2: End-to-end latency of one GPT-2 block ($d = 768$, $L = 16$, 2 parties) for CrypTen and PriX under each approximation mode, on CPU (left) and GPU (right). Labels give the PriX speedup.

Table 2: **CPU Transformer-block latency (ms) and PriX speedup** for all five approximation modes ($N = 2$ parties, $L = 16$; median of 3 timed runs). Host: AMD EPYC 7B12, 24 vCPUs; Python 3.13, JAX/jaxlib 0.12.0, PyTorch 2.14.1 (CPU). PriX uses its default peer-to-peer TCP transport; CrypTen uses `gloo` over TCP. All entries were measured in one session. Lower is better.

	CrypTen Approx.		Piecewise Poly		SHAFT (Fourier+ODE)		Curl Wavelet LUTs		Fission Evaluator	
Model	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**
BertTiny (2-Blk)	1423.31	**582.27 (2.44×)**	1687.14	**560.17 (3.01×)**	1010.66	**434.93 (2.32×)**	1106.85	**446.87 (2.48×)**	443.46	**163.33 (2.72×)**
BertBase (1-Blk)	2950.74	**737.85 (4.00×)**	2968.03	**733.66 (4.05×)**	3154.52	**735.38 (4.29×)**	2167.78	**582.69 (3.72×)**	2081.62	**449.65 (4.63×)**
GPT2 (1-Blk)	3480.96	**809.60 (4.30×)**	3524.84	**574.84 (6.13×)**	3915.11	**519.49 (7.54×)**	2702.19	**482.07 (5.61×)**	2776.97	**357.22 (7.77×)**
Llama (1-Blk)	2317.26	**566.54 (4.09×)**	2779.46	**612.08 (4.54×)**	3021.76	**600.14 (5.04×)**	2068.08	**525.26 (3.94×)**	2244.43	**463.35 (4.84×)**
ModernBert (1-Blk)	1899.87	**557.62 (3.41×)**	2099.36	**514.43 (4.08×)**	2236.08	**450.99 (4.96×)**	1685.12	**425.10 (3.96×)**	1432.81	**307.39 (4.66×)**

5.2 CPU Benchmarks

Tables 2 and 3 report the CPU results. PriX has lower latency than CrypTen in all 75 CPU configurations: Transformer-block speedups range from **2.32**× to **7.77**× (geometric mean 4.14×), and primitive speedups from 1.06× (Mul, `shaft` mode) to 13.25× (InvSqrt, `fission` mode).

- **Run-to-run noise.** ReLU has the same protocol in every mode, so its spread across modes gives a rough noise estimate. Within this session, CrypTen's ReLU took 30.1–36.9 ms in four modes and 42.0 ms in `fission` mode, where an extra evaluator process competes for the same host; PriX's took 9.5–13.3 ms. Single-operation speedups below about 1.2× (Mul in `crypten` and `shaft` modes, Exp in `shaft` mode) are within this noise. The host is a shared cloud VM, and absolute latencies vary between sessions: both frameworks ran about 25–40% slower (median) in this session than in an earlier one with the same software. Only comparisons within one session are meaningful, which is why all CPU numbers in this paper come from a single session.

- **Matrix multiplication.** On CPU, CrypTen uses PyTorch's `int64` matmul, which has no BLAS backend. PriX uses FP64 GEMM on limbs (Section 3.1), which explains the 3.8–

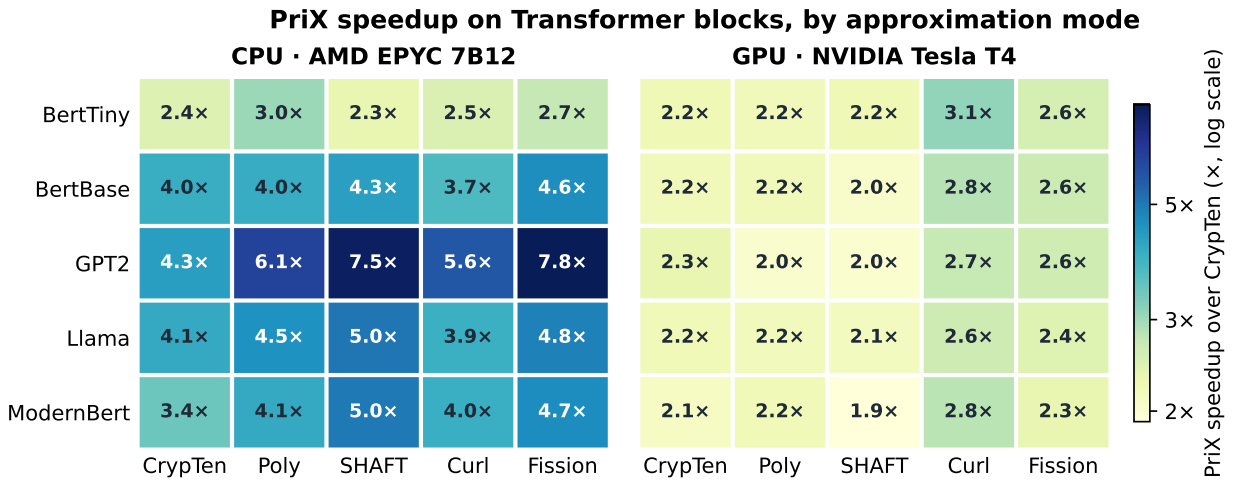


Figure 3: PriX speedup over CrypTen on all five Transformer blocks and all five approximation modes, on CPU and GPU (log color scale). The CrypTen `fission` column on CPU is affected by contention from the evaluator process (Section 5).

Table 3: **CPU primitive and nonlinearity latency (ms, CrypTen / PriX)** and PriX speedup (median of 5 timed runs; same host and session as Table 2).

Operation (Shape)	CrypTen Approx.	Piecewise Poly	SHAFT (Fourier+ODE)	Curl Wavelet LUTs	Fission Evaluator
Private MatMul (128 × 128)	23.89 / **5.82** (**4.10**×)	24.54 / **6.55** (**3.75**×)	25.05 / **6.15** (**4.08**×)	28.34 / **7.49** (**3.78**×)	29.61 / **7.70** (**3.84**×)
Private Mul (128 × 128)	5.29 / **4.95** (**1.07**×)	5.89 / **3.65** (**1.61**×)	4.85 / **4.57** (**1.06**×)	9.48 / **6.39** (**1.48**×)	6.90 / **4.47** (**1.54**×)
Comparison / ReLU (32 × 64)	32.52 / **9.46** (**3.44**×)	36.94 / **9.50** (**3.89**×)	31.10 / **10.06** (**3.09**×)	30.12 / **13.09** (**2.30**×)	41.98 / **13.25** (**3.17**×)
Exp (32 × 64)	21.08 / **14.97** (**1.41**×)	52.61 / **19.06** (**2.76**×)	20.77 / **17.73** (**1.17**×)	68.19 / **14.94** (**4.56**×)	10.90 / **2.67** (**4.08**×)
Reciprocal (32 × 64)	105.89 / **49.65** (**2.13**×)	128.86 / **40.38** (**3.19**×)	95.99 / **59.46** (**1.61**×)	50.35 / **9.53** (**5.29**×)	19.56 / **2.67** (**7.33**×)
InvSqrt (32 × 64)	65.45 / **34.43** (**1.90**×)	67.89 / **31.04** (**2.19**×)	69.75 / **45.42** (**1.54**×)	122.58 / **19.72** (**6.22**×)	20.26 / **1.53** (**13.25**×)
GeLU (32 × 64)	114.98 / **62.66** (**1.83**×)	59.24 / **24.05** (**2.46**×)	83.85 / **24.27** (**3.45**×)	34.11 / **8.18** (**4.17**×)	11.13 / **2.60** (**4.29**×)
SiLU (32 × 64)	83.53 / **39.35** (**2.12**×)	53.84 / **23.47** (**2.29**×)	74.87 / **34.21** (**2.19**×)	35.45 / **7.40** (**4.79**×)	12.00 / **1.80** (**6.68**×)
Softmax (4 × 32 × 32)	382.48 / **169.38** (**2.26**×)	442.88 / **159.95** (**2.77**×)	178.78 / **136.92** (**1.31**×)	378.89 / **120.87** (**3.13**×)	18.56 / **2.87** (**6.46**×)
LayerNorm (4 × 32 × 64)	75.40 / **28.37** (**2.66**×)	72.25 / **31.84** (**2.27**×)	76.07 / **40.36** (**1.88**×)	55.58 / **13.91** (**4.00**×)	21.72 / **3.07** (**7.07**×)

4.1× MatMul speedups in every mode. Linear layers dominate the $d = 768$ blocks, which is consistent with their larger end-to-end speedups (3.4–7.8×) compared with `BertTiny` (2.3–3.0×).

- **Comparisons and LUTs.** ReLU is 2.3–3.9× faster, consistent with fusing the local work of each SPK round and with its 20% smaller openings (Section 5.4). In `lut` mode, InvSqrt drops from 122.6 to 19.7 ms (6.22×), SiLU from 35.5 to 7.4 ms (4.79×), and LayerNorm from 55.6 to 13.9 ms (4.00×).
- **Piecewise polynomials.** `poly` mode makes GeLU and SiLU cheaper than `crypten` mode in both frameworks (in PriX, 24.1 vs. 62.7 ms and 23.5 vs. 39.4 ms), but more expensive than Curl's LUTs (8.2 and 7.4 ms). For exp, the piecewise polynomial is *slower* than the limit approximation (19.1 vs. 15.0 ms in PriX) because its secure comparisons cost more than 8 squarings.

5.3 GPU Benchmarks (NVIDIA Tesla T4, CUDA)

Tables 4 and 5 report the GPU results. PriX has lower latency in all 75 GPU configurations, with Transformer-block speedups of **1.91**×–**3.08**× (geometric mean 2.33×) and primitive speedups from

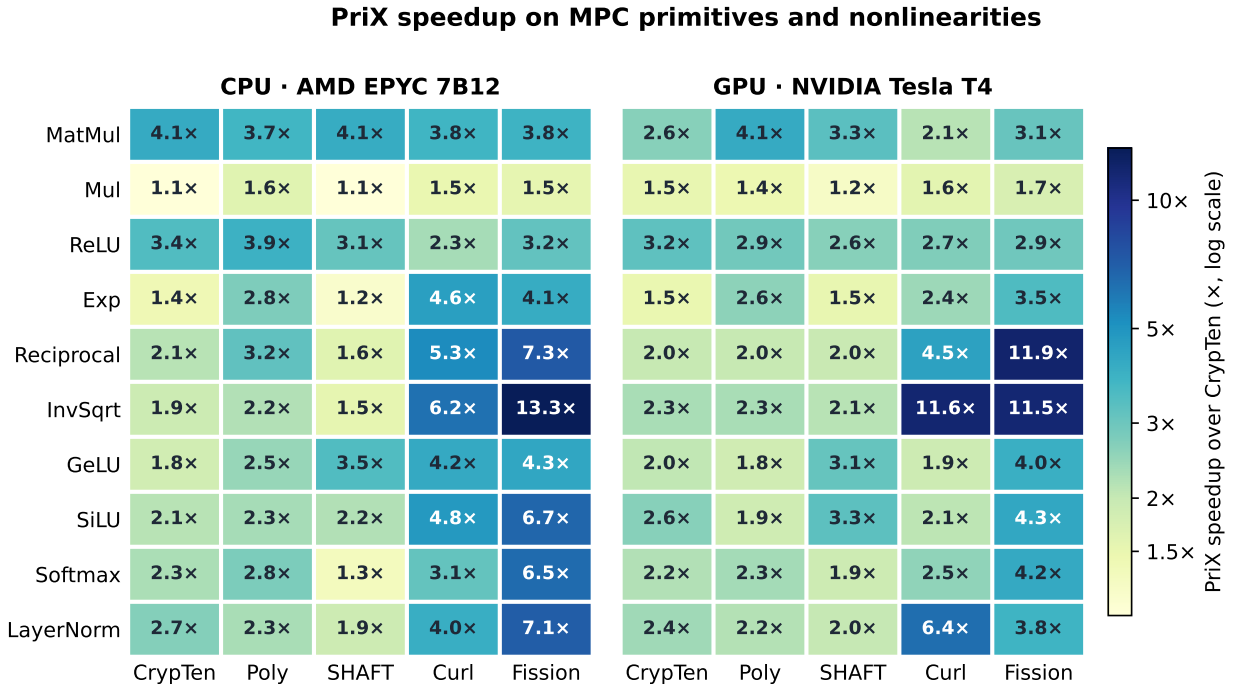


Figure 4: PriX speedup over CrypTen on the 10 MPC primitives and nonlinearities, on CPU and GPU (log color scale).

Table 4: **GPU (NVIDIA Tesla T4, Google Colab) Transformer-block latency (ms) and PriX speedup** for all five approximation modes ($N = 2$ parties, $L = 16$; median of 3 timed runs). PriX uses its default peer-to-peer TCP transport; CrypTen uses `gloo` over TCP. All entries were measured in one session. Lower is better.

	CrypTen Approx.		Piecewise Poly		SHAFT (Fourier+ODE)		Curl Wavelet LUTs		Fission Evaluator	
Model	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**	CrypTen	**PriX (Speedup)**
BertTiny (2-Blk)	1935.00	**867.19 (2.23×)**	1815.61	**826.13 (2.20×)**	1197.88	**537.35 (2.23×)**	1968.48	**639.19 (3.08×)**	396.46	**155.38 (2.55×)**
BertBase (1-Blk)	1662.57	**761.04 (2.18×)**	1676.78	**763.90 (2.20×)**	1321.44	**650.66 (2.03×)**	1694.65	**600.76 (2.82×)**	926.40	**350.81 (2.64×)**
GPT2 (1-Blk)	1663.77	**712.28 (2.34×)**	1609.94	**794.24 (2.03×)**	1290.56	**645.33 (2.00×)**	1634.65	**604.11 (2.71×)**	838.81	**320.92 (2.61×)**
Llama (1-Blk)	1632.13	**739.13 (2.21×)**	1580.11	**729.44 (2.17×)**	1286.35	**603.96 (2.13×)**	1728.45	**658.25 (2.63×)**	983.09	**402.74 (2.44×)**
ModernBert (1-Blk)	1445.26	**686.65 (2.10×)**	1390.71	**628.84 (2.21×)**	1085.58	**568.86 (1.91×)**	1480.95	**531.07 (2.79×)**	689.95	**297.91 (2.32×)**

1.23× (Mul, `shaft` mode) to 11.87× (Reciprocal, `fission` mode).

- **Run-to-run noise.** CrypTen's ReLU took 40.8–50.4 ms across the five modes; PriX's took 15.0–15.8 ms. PriX's MatMul was slower in `lut` mode (7.7 ms vs. 3.1–4.4 ms), where products use TruncPr rather than the communication-free local shift.
- **Comparisons.** CrypTen's ReLU on the GPU (41–50 ms) is slower than on CPU, consistent with many small kernel launches per SPK round. PriX takes 15.0–15.8 ms, a 2.6–3.2× speedup.
- **Wavelet LUTs.** In `lut` mode, InvSqrt drops from 141.2 to 12.2 ms (11.57×) and LayerNorm from 158.9 to 24.9 ms (6.38×). Both frameworks use the same Biorthogonal-2.2 configuration (one interval with a pair of slope/intercept tables). The gain comes from executing the same protocol with fewer launches and a faster local transport, not from a different algorithm.

Table 5: **GPU (NVIDIA Tesla T4) primitive and nonlinearity latency (ms, CrypTen / PriX)** and PriX speedup (median of 5 timed runs; same session as Table 4).

Operation (Shape)	CrypTen Approx.	Piecewise Poly	SHAFT (Fourier+ODE)	Curl Wavelet LUTs	Fission Evaluator
Private MatMul (128 × 128)	11.45 / **4.35 (2.63×)**	12.66 / **3.07 (4.12×)**	11.87 / **3.61 (3.29×)**	16.47 / **7.71 (2.14×)**	11.13 / **3.64 (3.05×)**
Private Mul (128 × 128)	4.91 / **3.23 (1.52×)**	4.51 / **3.12 (1.45×)**	4.08 / **3.31 (1.23×)**	8.59 / **5.42 (1.59×)**	4.99 / **2.89 (1.73×)**
Comparison / ReLU (32 × 64)	50.43 / **15.73 (3.21×)**	44.18 / **15.18 (2.91×)**	41.51 / **15.77 (2.63×)**	40.80 / **14.97 (2.73×)**	45.86 / **15.65 (2.93×)**
Exp (32 × 64)	28.30 / **19.07 (1.48×)**	79.72 / **31.14 (2.56×)**	27.03 / **17.71 (1.53×)**	67.40 / **28.30 (2.38×)**	6.85 / **1.97 (3.49×)**
Reciprocal (32 × 64)	129.92 / **65.24 (1.99×)**	134.66 / **68.01 (1.98×)**	137.68 / **69.79 (1.97×)**	56.21 / **12.59 (4.47×)**	17.61 / **1.48 (11.87×)**
InvSqrt (32 × 64)	90.38 / **39.73 (2.28×)**	87.97 / **38.64 (2.28×)**	85.92 / **40.36 (2.13×)**	141.19 / **12.20 (11.57×)**	17.45 / **1.52 (11.49×)**
GeLU (32 × 64)	150.42 / **73.75 (2.04×)**	68.45 / **37.10 (1.84×)**	92.71 / **29.91 (3.10×)**	23.39 / **12.35 (1.89×)**	6.81 / **1.71 (3.98×)**
SiLU (32 × 64)	132.88 / **50.49 (2.63×)**	67.45 / **36.06 (1.87×)**	90.73 / **27.87 (3.26×)**	26.20 / **12.55 (2.09×)**	7.30 / **1.71 (4.26×)**
Softmax (4 × 32 × 32)	551.32 / **251.27 (2.19×)**	586.34 / **252.38 (2.32×)**	199.67 / **106.15 (1.88×)**	507.15 / **200.35 (2.53×)**	7.23 / **1.74 (4.15×)**
LayerNorm (4 × 32 × 64)	103.48 / **43.67 (2.37×)**	103.03 / **47.66 (2.16×)**	99.32 / **49.61 (2.00×)**	158.90 / **24.92 (6.38×)**	9.46 / **2.48 (3.81×)**

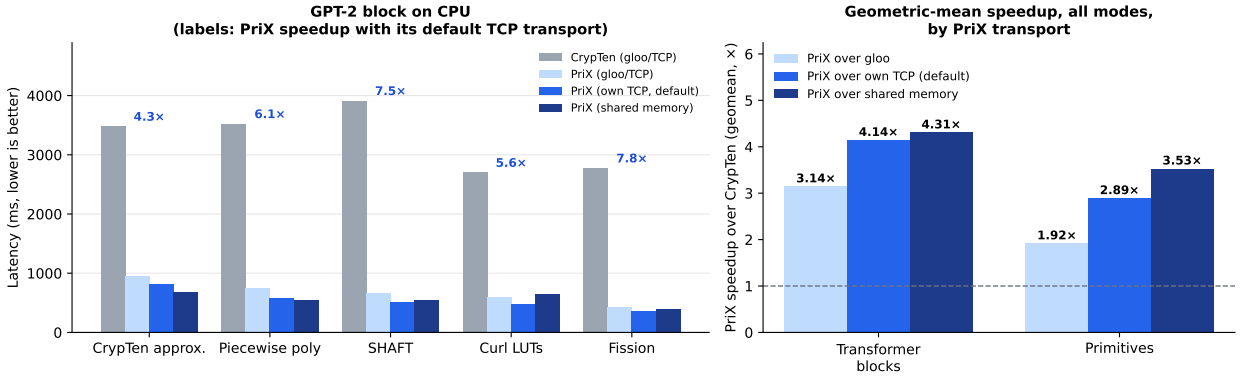


Figure 5: Transport comparison on CPU. Left: GPT-2 block latency for CrypTen and for PriX over `gloo`, its own TCP transport (default), and shared memory; labels give PriX's speedup with its default transport. Right: geometric-mean speedup over all modes for each PriX transport.

- **SHAFT and piecewise polynomials.** Fourier GeLU drops from 92.7 to 29.9 ms (3.10×) and ODE Softmax from 199.7 to 106.2 ms (1.88×). Piecewise-polynomial GeLU and SiLU take 36–37 ms in PriX, between SHAFT (28–30 ms) and the `crypten` approximations (50–74 ms). As on CPU, the piecewise exp is slower than the limit approximation (31.1 vs. 19.1 ms).
- **End-to-end.** Transformer-block speedups are smaller on GPU (1.91–3.08×) than on CPU. Plausible causes are the T4's low FP64 throughput and host-side communication, which faster GPU kernels do not reduce. We have not profiled this split.

5.4 Transport Comparison: How Much Does the Transport Matter?

CrypTen and PriX use different transports (Section 3.4), so the speedups above combine PriX's compiled local computation with differences in how messages are moved. To separate the two, we ran PriX over each of its three transports in the same sessions as Tables 2–5: its default peer-to-peer TCP transport (the configuration in those tables); `torch.distributed/gloo` over TCP, i.e. CrypTen's own transport, by routing PriX's two-party `all_reduce` through it; and the shared-memory transport. Everything else in PriX (compiled kernels, limb matrix multiplication, batching, host staging) is unchanged, and all three variants produce the same results. Table 6 and Figure 5 summarize the results as geometric means.

- **Most of the speedup does not depend on the transport.** Even over CrypTen's own `gloo` transport, PriX is 3.14× faster than CrypTen on Transformer blocks on CPU (2.50–

Table 6: **PriX speedup over CrypTen by PriX transport, on CPU and GPU** (geometric means over the 5 Transformer blocks or the 10 primitives of each mode; same sessions as Tables 2 and 4). CrypTen always uses `gloo` over TCP. "gloo" runs PriX over that same transport.

	Transformer blocks			**Primitives**		
Platform / Mode	TCP (default)	gloo	Shared mem.	TCP (default)	gloo	Shared mem.
CPU (AMD EPYC 7B12)						
CrypTen approx.	3.58×	2.50×	3.76×	2.14×	1.35×	2.88×
Piecewise poly	4.25×	3.21×	4.98×	2.63×	1.59×	3.08×
SHAFT	4.51×	3.73×	5.22×	1.93×	1.48×	2.89×
Curl LUTs	3.81×	2.77×	3.35×	3.70×	2.05×	4.13×
Fission	4.66×	3.71×	4.52×	5.00×	3.97×	5.17×
All modes (CPU)	**4.14**×	**3.14**×	**4.31**×	**2.89**×	**1.92**×	**3.53**×
GPU (NVIDIA Tesla T4)						
CrypTen approx.	2.21×	1.96×	2.32×	2.18×	1.74×	2.33×
Piecewise poly	2.16×	1.94×	2.33×	2.26×	1.77×	2.37×
SHAFT	2.06×	2.08×	2.35×	2.19×	1.75×	2.45×
Curl LUTs	2.80×	2.47×	2.87×	3.06×	2.35×	3.07×
Fission	2.51×	2.46×	2.47×	4.26×	3.84×	4.54×
All modes (GPU)	**2.33**×	**2.17**×	**2.46**×	**2.69**×	**2.17**×	**2.85**×

3.73× across modes) and 2.17× on GPU (1.94–2.47×), and 1.92× (CPU) / 2.17× (GPU) faster on primitives.

- **CrypTen's `gloo` path is slower than a lean TCP transport.** PriX's own TCP transport is 1.32× faster than `gloo` on CPU blocks (1.51× on primitives) and 1.07× faster on GPU blocks (1.24× on primitives), so part of CrypTen's latency is its transport: `gloo` adds tensor conversions and collective-library overhead to every opening.

- **Shared memory adds little over TCP.** PriX over shared memory is only 4–5% faster than over TCP on blocks (4.31× vs. 4.14× on CPU; 2.46× vs. 2.33× on GPU), and 22% (CPU) / 6% (GPU) faster on the small, round-bound primitives, where per-round latency dominates. For openings above 16 MiB, TCP is faster, because the shared-memory transport falls back to pickled queues (46 vs. 162 ms for a 19 MB opening). We therefore made TCP the default; shared memory remains available as a single-host shortcut.

- **Fission mode depends least on the transport**, because it needs very few rounds between the MPC parties (about 14 per GPT-2 block, versus 98–176 in the other modes).

- **Communication is similar, but not identical.** In `crypten` mode, the two frameworks' round counts agree to within one round and their byte counts to within 5% on every Transformer block (e.g. 176 rounds and 80.1 vs. 79.7 MB for a GPT-2 block). Two PriX protocol changes account for most of the remaining differences:

  – *Smaller comparison openings.* In each carry-lookahead round, one masked vector P_0 is ANDed with both S_1 and P_1. CrypTen first copies P_0 to the shape of $[S_1, P_1]$ and therefore masks and opens it twice (its source marks this with a TODO); PriX uses a triple $(a, [b_1, b_2], [a \wedge b_1, a \wedge b_2])$ and opens $P_0 \oplus a$ once, as matrix Beaver triples do for a shared operand. The opened values are still uniformly masked by fresh triples, so security is unchanged. This cuts a comparison from 29 to 23 words per element (ReLU:

0.38 vs. 0.48 MB), and `poly`-mode blocks send 5–16% fewer bytes (GPT-2: 88.8 vs. 96.4 MB).

– *Batched range tests in SHAFT.* PriX obtains $[x < 0]$ and $[|x| < w]$ from one comparison over the stacked tensor $[x, x-w, -x-w]$, while the SHAFT reference runs two sequential comparisons. This saves 8 rounds per GeLU/SiLU (11 vs. 19) and per SHAFT-mode block (GPT-2: 98 vs. 106), at the cost of about 4% more bytes.

PriX takes more rounds in two places, both because it applies a configuration setting that the CrypTen code ignores. In `lut` mode, Curl truncates squares with the communication-free local shift even though the mode specifies TruncPr for products (its multiplications do use TruncPr); PriX uses TruncPr for both, so its LayerNorm takes one extra round and each block two (GPT-2: 113 vs. 111). In `crypten` mode, CrypTen's sigmoid sets exp to 9 squarings in a configuration override that does not enclose the exp call, so it runs with the default 8; PriX applies the override, so its SiLU takes 25 rounds versus 24 and is about twice as accurate (Section 5.5). Apart from `shaft` mode, PriX's speedups therefore do not come from fewer rounds.

We also recorded the time spent inside communication calls, but for PriX this does not separate cleanly from computation. JAX dispatches device work asynchronously, and the copy to the host at the start of each communication call waits for that work to finish, so compute time is attributed to communication. The transport swap above avoids this problem because it compares end-to-end latencies.

5.5 Approximation Accuracy and Valid Input Ranges

The latency results above say nothing about whether each mode computes the right function. Table 7 reports the error of each nonlinearity in PriX's default configuration of each mode, measured on CPU with two parties against exact float64 results (`benchmarks/accuracy_sweep.py`). Each function is evaluated 10 times on a fixed grid of 241–257 points (softmax: $4 \times 32 \times 32$ logits drawn from $\mathcal{N}(0, 2^2)$; LayerNorm: $4 \times 32 \times 64$ inputs from $\mathcal{N}(0.5, 2^2)$), because probabilistic truncation and the masks make the error vary between runs.

No mode is accurate everywhere, and inputs outside a mode's valid range are neither clamped nor flagged:

- **`lut` (wavelet LUTs).** Curl's original defaults cover narrow ranges ($[0, 2)$ for $1/\sqrt{x}$ and $|x| < 4$ for GeLU, which caused LayerNorm to wrap whenever a row's variance was 2 or more and GeLU to wrap for $|x| \geq 4$) and suffer from an intermittent Softmax failure (≈ -461 on 3–4% of calls in both PriX and the Curl reference). Tracing the wavelet tables explains the Softmax failure: Biorthogonal-2.2's decomposition filter has negative side lobes ($-1/8$), so the $1/x$ pole at $x = 2^{-16}$ gives bin $k = 1$ of the reciprocal table a large negative knot (≈ -4968). With Curl's 2^7-bin reciprocal table on $[0, 64)$, bin $k = 1$ spans $[0.5, 1.0)$, while Curl's 2^5-bin negative-exponential table on $[0, 64)$ evaluates $\widehat{\exp}(0) = 0.924 < 1$. Whenever a Softmax row has one dominant logit, the sum of exponentials falls in $[0.924, 1.0)$ and lands in bin $k = 1$ whenever TruncPr rounds down. PriX therefore sets `inv_sqrt.lut_max_bits` $= 4$ ($[0, 16)$), `gelu.lut_max_bits` $= 3$ ($[-8, 8]$), `exp.lut_max_bits` $= 4$ ($\widehat{\exp}(0) = 0.992$), and `reciprocal.bior_size_bits` $= 8$ (moving $[0.75, 1.0)$ to bin $k = 3$), which fixes LayerNorm, GeLU on $[-6, 6]$, and Softmax without changing the table sizes or the communication volume (the latency benchmarks above use these defaults in both frameworks). Even with these defaults, $1/\sqrt{x}$ wraps for $x \geq 16$, exp assumes non-positive inputs (`all_neg = True`), and $1/x$,

Table 7: **Approximation error by mode** (default configuration of each mode, 2 parties, 10 runs, CPU). Each cell is the median absolute error / the typical (median over runs) worst-case absolute error within one run. Bold marks a worst-case error above 0.1; † marks functions for which at least one run had an error above 1.

Function (inputs)	`crypten`	`poly`	`shaft`	`lut`	`fission`
exp, $[-8, 0]$	4e-4 / 1e-3	2e-3 / 0.011	4e-4 / 1e-3	3e-4 / **0.12**	4e-6
exp, $[-4, 2]$	1e-3 / 0.070	3e-3 / 0.011	1e-3 / 0.056	9e-3 / **7.4**†	5e-6
log, $[0.1, 50]$	0.020 / 0.033	0.020 / 0.032	0.020 / 0.033	1e-5 / **2.0**†	4e-6
$1/x$, $[0.1, 50]$	9e-5 / 6e-4	9e-5 / 6e-4	9e-5 / 6e-4	7e-6 / **1.6e4**†	3e-6
$1/\sqrt{x}$, $[0.05, 50]$	2e-5 / **0.24**	2e-5 / **0.24**	2e-5 / **0.24**	**0.13** / **193**†	4e-6
Sigmoid, $[-8, 8]$	2e-4 / 2e-3	1e-3 / 9e-3	0.019 / **0.50**	5e-5 / 4e-3	4e-6
Tanh, $[-6, 6]$	1e-4 / 4e-3	1e-3 / 0.018	0.035 / 0.093	2e-5 / 9e-3	3e-6
Erf, $[-4, 4]$	**0.24** / **7.2e4**†	2e-3 / 0.015	0.027 / 0.071	5e-5 / 0.011	3e-6
GeLU, $[-6, 6]$	**0.92** / **1.4e6**†	4e-4 / 4e-3	4e-4 / 4e-3	3e-4 / **0.13**	3e-6
SiLU, $[-8, 8]$	6e-4 / 2e-3	5e-3 / 0.015	6e-4 / 5e-3	3e-3 / **0.32**	4e-6
Softmax	1e-4 / 4e-3	6e-4 / 6e-3	3e-4 / 0.052	1e-4 / 0.015	4e-6
LayerNorm	9e-6 / 9e-5	9e-6 / 8e-5	1e-5 / 1e-4	1e-5 / 9e-5	4e-6

$1/\sqrt{x}$, and log remain inaccurate in their first two bins near 0 because of the Biorthogonal-2.2 boundary sidelobe.

- **`crypten`.** Erf and GeLU use an 8-term Taylor series that is accurate to 3×10^{-4} on $|x| \leq 1.75$ (GeLU: 10^{-4} on $|x| \leq 2.0$) but diverges for $|x| \gtrsim 2.5$, as in CrypTen. The Newton–Raphson $1/\sqrt{x}$ loses accuracy near the bottom of its range.
- **`shaft`.** The Fourier series are periodic, so Sigmoid and Tanh oscillate near the edge of the period ($|x| \approx 8$ by default).
- `poly` stays within about 0.02 on its fitted intervals, and `fission` is exact to float32 precision (its column shows the median error only).

Comparison with the CrypTen/Curl reference. On identical inputs (10 runs each), PriX is more accurate than the reference implementation on three functions, because of three bugs in the reference code rather than any protocol difference. (1) CrypTen's `var()` inverts its `unbiased` flag and divides by $n-1$ when asked for the biased variance, so every non-`fission` LayerNorm output is scaled by $\sqrt{(n-1)/n}$ (0.9922 for $n = 64$; a least-squares fit of Curl's outputs gives 0.9921). Curl's `lut`-mode LayerNorm has a median error of 5.4×10^{-3} versus 1.0×10^{-5} for PriX; the bias shrinks with width (about 0.07% at $d = 768$). (2) The ineffective exp override described in Section 5.4 roughly doubles the error of CrypTen's `crypten`-mode SiLU (median 1.1×10^{-3} versus 5.6×10^{-4}). (3) CrypTen's integer `pow(p)` computes $(x^3)^{(p-1)/2} = x^{3(p-1)/2}$ instead of $(x^2)^{(p-1)/2} \cdot x = x^p$ for odd $p \geq 5$, which replaces odd powers x^5, x^9, x^{13}, x^{17} in its Taylor `erf` with even powers $x^6, x^{12}, x^{18}, x^{24}$ (raising its `erf` error on $[-1.5, 1.5]$ from 3×10^{-4} to 3.3 and its median error on $[-4, 4]$ from 0.24 to 2.5×10^3). None of these bugs changes the number of multiplications or the cost of the computation, so the latency comparison is unaffected. While preparing this evaluation, we found and fixed a bug in PriX's `fission` mode: when the right operand of a multiplication still carried a deferred truncation, the product was labelled with the wrong fixed-point scale, which made attention scores about 2^{16} times too small and attention nearly uniform. The fix changes only the scale label, not the protocol steps that run, so it does not affect the latencies above, which were

measured before it. The reference implementations of Curl and Fission in the CrypTen baseline do not have this bug. We have not measured end-to-end model accuracy.

6 Security Considerations and Limitations

PriX is a research framework operating in the **semi-honest (honest-but-curious)** model, and its current implementation has the following limitations:

1. **Correlated Randomness Providers (`TFP` vs. `TTP`):** Like CrypTen [12], PriX defaults to the Trusted First Party (`TFP`) provider, in which Party 0 generates the Beaver triples, truncation pairs, and LUT correlations. Party 0 therefore knows the dealer randomness and can recover every secret; `TFP` is suitable only for performance measurement, and all experiments in this report use it for both frameworks. Setting `cfg.mpc.provider = "TTP"` runs a separate dealer process (`TTPServer`) under the usual non-colluding third-party assumption.

2. **Pseudorandom Number Generation:** Correlated randomness is currently expanded with `SplitMix64` (inside compiled kernels) and `PCG64` (on the host), seeded from OS entropy exchanged at initialization. Neither generator is a cryptographically secure PRF, so a party that observes part of a stream may predict the rest. Replacing them with a keyed counter-mode PRF (e.g. Threefry or AES-CTR) is required before PriX can protect real data.

3. **Probabilistic Truncation Range:** PriX's TruncPr [5] is instantiated with parameter $\ell = 62$ in $\mathbb{Z}_{2^{64}}$: the opened value is $2^{64-\ell-1}(x + 2^{\ell-1} + r)$ with a uniform ℓ-bit mask r and a masked carry bit. The opening hides x regardless of its value; the range condition $|x| < 2^{\ell-1} = 2^{61}$ on the ring integer is needed for *correctness*. With $f = 16$, this means real values below 2^{29} in magnitude for products at precision $2f$, and below 2^{45} for values at precision f. Values outside this range give incorrect results without any error being raised. As usual, the truncated result may be off by one unit in the last place.

4. **Implementation Hardening:** The `TTP` dealer enforces an RPC method allowlist, cached wavelet lookup tables are stored in a per-user (`0700`) directory with parameter hashes, and the peer-to-peer `tcp` transport uses a pickle-free wire format with optional mutual TLS. However, the legacy `jax.distributed` key-value store transport and on-disk tuple cache still use Python `pickle` without encryption or authentication, and Party 0 drives `TTP` and evaluator control messages.

5. **Evaluation Scope:** All measurements are single-host, with no network emulation; they characterize computation and local inter-process overhead, not wide-area deployment. We report the accuracy of individual nonlinearities (Section 5.5) but not end-to-end model accuracy. PriX has been tested on CPUs and CUDA GPUs only. On TPUs, its FP64 limb matrix multiplication would rely on emulated double precision.

7 Related Work

MPC frameworks for machine learning. CrypTen [12] is the PyTorch framework on which Curl, Fission, and our baseline build. MP-SPDZ [11] compiles programs for a large set of MPC protocols and security models, but targets general computation rather than tensor workloads. The closest system to PriX is SecretFlow-SPU [16], which also compiles machine-learning programs (including JAX) through XLA: SPU lowers the whole program to its own IR and executes it with a

C++ runtime over several protocols, whereas PriX stays in Python, compiles only the local phases between openings with JAX itself, and aims at fast prototyping of CrypTen-style approximation methods. PUMA [4] is implemented on SPU.

GPU acceleration. CryptGPU [22] runs CrypTen-style 3-party protocols on GPUs and introduced the floating-point limb decomposition for ring matrix multiplication that CrypTen's CUDA backend uses; PriX refines it by computing only the limb products that survive modulo 2^{64}. Piranha [25] is a general GPU platform for secret-sharing MPC, and SIGMA [7] evaluates GPT models on GPUs with function secret sharing.

Private Transformer inference. Besides the methods PriX implements [21, 4, 15, 10, 23], two-party systems combining homomorphic encryption with secret sharing, such as Iron [8], BOLT [18], and BumbleBee [9], target the client–server setting with lower communication, and MPCFormer [14] replaces nonlinearities with MPC-friendly ones and recovers accuracy by distillation. These are complementary: PriX's contribution is an execution engine for secret-sharing protocols, not a new approximation or protocol.

8 Conclusion

We presented **PriX**, a JAX/XLA framework for privacy-preserving Transformer research via Secure Multi-Party Computation. PriX implements five MPC approximation paradigms (**CrypTen**, **piecewise polynomials**, **SHAFT**, **Curl**, and **Fission**) behind one API. It compiles the local steps of each protocol with XLA, computes only the surviving limb products in its exact FP64 ring matrix multiplication, and communicates over a pickle-free peer-to-peer TCP transport that also runs across machines. On a single host, it has lower latency than the PyTorch CrypTen baseline in every configuration we measured, with Transformer-block speedups of **2.32**×–**7.77**× on CPU and **1.91**×–**3.08**× on a Tesla T4 GPU. Over CrypTen's own transport, PriX is still 3.14× faster on Transformer blocks on CPU and 2.17× on GPU (geometric means). Evaluating over real networks, measuring end-to-end model accuracy, and replacing the non-cryptographic PRNGs are the main next steps. PriX is open-source and available on PyPI via `pip install prix-jax`.

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